

DAVID ORVEK

Curriculum Vitae

EDUCATION

Indiana University

Ph.D. in Music Theory

Anticipated December 2025

Minors in Music History and Guitar Performance

Dissertation (working title): “Experiencing the Music of Brian Ferneyhough”

Advisor: Andrew Mead

The Ohio State University

M.A. in Music Theory

2019

Thesis: [“Generalized Transformational Voice-Leading Systems”](#)

Advisor: David Clampitt

Southern Adventist University

B.S. in Music Theory and Literature, *summa cum laude*

2016

Honors thesis: [“Ex Nihilo: An Inquiry into the Nature of Musical Composition”](#)

Advisors: J. Bruce Ashton and Daniel Maxwell

TEACHING POSITIONS

Butler University

Lecturer in Music Theory

Fall 2024–present

Instructor of Music Theory (full time)

Spring 2023–Spring 2024

Adjunct Instructor of Music Theory

Fall 2022

Indiana University

Graduate Associate Instructor

Fall 2019–Summer 2023

The Ohio State University

Graduate Teaching Associate

Fall 2017–Spring 2019

Southern Adventist University

Teacher’s Assistant

Fall 2014–Fall 2016

COURSES TAUGHT

Butler University

Aural Skills Fundamentals	Fall 2025
Special section of Aural Skills I for students who need more help	
Aural Skills I	Fall 2025
Core aural skills course for undergraduate music majors	
Analysis of Music since 1900	Spring 2025
Master's-level seminar	
Analysis of Tonal Music	Spring 2024
Master's-level seminar	
Graduate Music Theory Review	Fall 2023
Remedial course for graduate music students	
Form and Analysis	Fall 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025
Upper-level undergraduate course on form	
Counterpoint	Spring 2023, 2025
Upper-level undergraduate introduction to modal and tonal counterpoint	
Music Theory 4	Spring 2023, 2024, 2025
Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors	
Music Theory 3	Fall 2023, 2024
Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors	
Music Theory 2	Spring 2023, 2024
Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors	
Aural Skills 3	Fall 2022, 2024, 2025
Core aural skills course for undergraduate music majors	

Indiana University***Instructor of Record***

Written Theory Review for Graduate Students	Summer 2023
Remedial course for graduate music students	
Musical Skills IV	Summer 2022

Core aural skills course for undergraduate music majors

Musical Skills II

Fall 2021, Spring 2022

Core aural skills course for undergraduate music majors

Under Faculty Supervision

Music Theory and Literature IV

Spring 2021

Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors

Music Theory and Literature III

Fall 2020

Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors

Music Theory and Literature II

Spring 2020

Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors

Music Theory and Literature I

Fall 2019

Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors

The Ohio State University (under faculty supervision)

Aural Training II

Spring 2018, 2019

Core aural skills course for undergraduate music majors

Aural Training I

Fall 2017, 2018

Core aural skills course for undergraduate music majors

Music Theory II

Spring 2018, 2019

Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors

Music Theory I

Fall 2017, 2018

Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors

Southern Adventist University (under faculty supervision)

Instructor

Basic Musicianship

Fall 2014

Remedial theory course for undergraduate music majors

Teacher's Assistant

Music Theory III

Fall 2015, 2016

Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors

Music Theory IV

Spring 2016

Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors

Music Theory II

Spring 2015

Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors

Music Theory I

Fall 2014

Core written theory course for undergraduate music majors

REFEREED PUBLICATIONS

Orvek, David E. ["Ungrading in the Music Theory Classroom: A One-Year Case Study."](#) *Journal of Music Theory Pedagogy* 38 (2024): 45–69.

Orvek, David, and David Clampitt. ["SUM Classes and Quotient Generalized Interval Systems."](#) In *Mathematics and Computation in Music: 8th International Conference, MCM 2022, Atlanta, GA, USA, June 21–24, 2022*, edited by Mariana Montiel, Octavio A. Agustín-Aquino, Francisco Gómez, Jeremy Kastine, Emilio Lluís-Puebla, and Brent Milam, 99–111. Cham: Springer, 2022.

INVITED TALKS

"'Like a Piece of Woven Material': Unity and Organicism in Elizabeth Maconchy's String Quartet No. 11"

Hartt School Music Theory Colloquium — University of Hartford

2022

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS AND POSTERS

"Experiencing the Music of Brian Ferneyhough"

Society for Music Theory, Minneapolis, MN

2025

"Ungrading in the Music Theory Classroom: A One-Year Case Study"

Pedagogy into Practice, University of Oklahoma

2024

"Ungrading, Trust, and Artificial Intelligence"

Music Theory Pedagogy Interest Group, Denver, CO

2023

"Germaine Tailleferre's Experiment with Serial Composition"

Patterns and Singularities, Indiana University

2023

"SUM Classes and Quotient Generalized Interval Systems" (with David Clampitt)

Mathematics and Computation in Music, Atlanta, GA

2022

“‘Like a Piece of Woven Material’: Unity and Organicism in Elizabeth Maconchy’s String Quartet No. 11”

Society for Music Theory, Online 2021

“Schubert, Schoenberg, and Some Extensions to Cohn’s Sum-Class System”

Society for Music Theory, Online (poster) 2020

South-Central Society for Music Theory, Nashville, TN 2020

“Closural Features in Non-Tonal Music: A Corpus Study of the Music of Schoenberg, Webern, and Berg”

Indiana University Symposium of Research in Music, Bloomington, IN 2019

“Ex Nihilo: An Inquiry into the Nature of Musical Composition”

Southern Adventist University Campus Research Day, Collegedale, TN 2016

AWARDS

Commendation for exemplary performance in the PhD oral exam 2022
Indiana University

[Wennerstrom Music Theory Associate Instructor Fellowship](#) 2022
Indiana University
Annual departmental award for outstanding achievement in teaching

Graduate Associate Award 2019
The Ohio State University
Annual departmental award for outstanding achievement in teaching

Top Achiever Award for Academic Excellence 2016
Southern Adventist University

RELATED WORK EXPERIENCE

Editorial Assistant: Music Theory Spectrum 2024–present

Curriculum Designer: Music Fundamentals Online 2021

Office Assistant: School of Music, Southern Adventist University 2015–2016

Choral Librarian: School of Music, Southern Adventist University 2014–2016

ADVISING

Butler University***Advisor***

Christian Miller, Butler Summer Institute project	Summer 2025
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Cameron Storey, Music Theory Emphasis paper	Spring 2024
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Committee Member

Charissa Garrigus, MA Musicology thesis	Spring 2025
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INSTITUTIONAL SERVICE

Butler University

Program for Undergraduate Research Committee	Fall 2024–present
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SERVICE TO THE FIELD

Program Committee: IU Symposium of Research in Music	2022 & 2023
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Organizer and Panel Member: Southern Scholars Experiencing Grad School Q & A Q & A session for undergraduates interested in graduate school	2021
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Music Theory Midwest Technology Committee	2020–2023 (chair 2021–2023)
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Co-Editor: Indiana Theory Review, vols. 37 & 38	2020–2023
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Treasurer: Graduate Theory Association, Indiana University	2020–2021
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RELATED SKILLS

Programming

Python, Music21, Humdrum, Bash, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, PHP

Languages

German (novice), French (novice)